

## ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

### PART A Group Interaction

This article appeared in an international newspaper:

#### Should there be an age limit for political leaders?

The US President Donald Trump is 71 years old. Dr. Mahathir became the Prime Minister of Malaysia at 92. Isn't it time we considered age limits to make room for a younger generation of leaders?

There certainly are some benefits to having older political leaders: they can draw on the wisdom and life experience gained over decades of high-level decision-making. But there's also no doubt that being a world leader includes work and travel requirements that can be physically demanding and difficult for some older people to handle, not to mention the mental attentiveness that is needed to stay focused.

Perhaps the biggest issue that surrounds elderly leaders is whether or not they are able to understand the modern world. Some have questioned how people who grew up decades ago can possibly understand young people today. Younger leaders, like French President Emmanuel Macron at 39, are equipped with a more personal understanding of the current issues and some might say are more able to guide the new generation in the coming years.

With an aging population, this problem is becoming increasingly recognized, and in some countries there have been attempts to introduce legal age limits for heads of state or government. France recommended banning politicians over 70 from standing for election but the idea was rejected because it might be considered discrimination against someone based on their age.

Your school is planning on holding a summer course called 'Developing Young Hong Kong Leaders'. Your class has been asked to discuss this topic. You may want to talk about:

- what skills a political leader needs in today's society
- the strengths and limitations of older leaders
- whether age should be a factor in choosing a leader
- anything else you think is important

### PART B Individual Response

1. Would you like to be a leader?
2. Would you prefer to have a younger or an older leader?
3. What is the biggest advantage younger leaders have?
4. Should older leaders be respected because of their age?
5. Do older leaders understand young people?
6. How important is life experience for leaders?
7. Should there be age limits on leaders?
8. Does society discriminate against the elderly?